

Jewish Tallage; and for this he had a salary of 10*l.* per annum. In the following year, 1276, he was appointed *Custos Brevium* of the Court of Common Pleas; and in 11 Edward I., the lands of Isabella, the widow of Henry de Gaunt, were committed to his custody. On June 18, 1286, 14 Edward I., he was associated with the escheator in the custody of the bishoprick of Ely on its becoming vacant; and in the course of the same year he was appointed a baron of the Exchequer in the place of Roger de Northwood, with a salary of 20*l.* a year; and there is evidence of his continuance in that office for the four following years.¹ He probably was some relation to the Bishop of Norwich of the same name, who died in August, 1288.

MONTEFORTI, HENRY DE.

Just. C. P. 1272.

See under the Reign of Henry III.

THE name of Henry de Monteforti, with the addition of "Clericus," appears in 48 Henry III., 1263, as an escheator south of the Trent²; and in the same year he was one of the conservators of the peace in the county of Kent.³

I have not been able to discover whether any relationship existed between him and Peter de Montfort, the head of the noble family of that name, or Simon Earl of Leicester; but as both of the latter were slain in 1265 at the battle of Evesham, in arms against their sovereign, it is not likely that the connection was very close; since Henry's elevation to the bench took place about October, 1266, 50 Henry III., from which date till the end of that reign the Fine Rolls contain frequent entries of writs for assizes to be held before

¹ Madox's Exch. i. 234. 243. 313., ii. 322.; Abbrev. Rot. Orig. i. 45.; Dugdale's Chron. Series.

² Excerpt. e Rot. Fin. ii. 411.

³ Hasted's Kent, i. 218.

him.¹ In 51 Henry III. the keeper of the wardrobe was commanded by the king to provide "*Johanni le Breton et Henrico de Monteforti, Justiciariis suis,*" with the entire robes other justiciars received.² He went circuits in 52, 55, and 56 Henry III., and was still on the bench at the decease of that king.

There can be little doubt that he was continued in office on the accession of Edward I.; for in the second and fourth years of that reign he again acted on the circuits, the commission of the former year extending over nineteen counties. Dugdale also quotes an entry on the Liberate Rolls of 3 Edward I., in which he is named as a justice of the bench.³ He died at the end of the next or beginning of the following year.⁴

MORTIMER, WILLIAM DE.

JUST. ITIN. 1292.

See under the Reign of Edward II.

MUTFORD, JOHN DE.

JUST. ITIN. T. 1307.

See under the Reign of Edward II.

NEWBALD, GEOFFREY DE.

JUST. ITIN. 1276.

DUGDALE, by a misreading of the patent he quotes, states that on November 2, 1276, 4 Edward I., Geoffrey de Newbald was appointed one of the judges of the Common Pleas⁵; the record plainly proving that he was merely constituted a

¹ Excerpt. e Rot. Fin. ii. 446—586.

² Selden's Notes to Hengham Magna, 5.

³ Dugdale's Chron. Series.

⁴ Abbrev. Rot. Orig. i. 27.

⁵ Dugdale's Chron. Series.

justice to hold pleas in the liberties of the priory of Dunstable. He was soon removed to a more important station, for on August 22, 1277, he was raised to the office of Chancellor of the Exchequer, for which he had a salary of forty marks.¹ In 6 Edward I. he complained to the parliament that the Bishop of Durham had refused to admit him to the church of Roubery in that diocese, in the king's gift, alleging it was already full; and his petition was referred to the Court Christian.² He is recorded as attending the Court of Exchequer as late as 9 Edward I.

NORMANVILL, THOMAS DE.

Just. Itin. ? 1286. 1293.

THERE was a Yorkshire family of this name; of whom Gerard and Margery his wife, who were, perhaps, the parents of Thomas de Normanvill, paid for an assize in that county in 53 Henry III., 1269.³ Thomas is called "senescallus regis" in the king's grant to him, in 4 Edward I., of the custody of the Castle of Bamburgh; and the title is continued in numerous instances till the tenth year, when he was appointed to the same duties under the designation of king's escheator beyond Trent. He retained the latter office till the twenty-third year, except that he exchanged it for a short time for the southern escheatorship.⁴ It was probably in this official capacity that in 11 Edward I., 1283, he received the king's commands to remove the sheriff of Cumberland; his commission for which, and his letters to the barons of the Exchequer communicating his having obeyed the order, are mentioned in the Year Book of that reign (fol. 12.). He was one of the justices itinerant for pleas

¹ Madox's Exch. ii. 52. 62. 321.

² Rot. Parl. i. 6.

³ Excerpt. e Rot. Fin. ii. 491.

⁴ Abbrev. Rot. Orig. i. 26—88.

of the forest only in Nottingham and Lancashire in 14 Edward I., 1286, but his name appears as a regular justice itinerant in 20 and 21 Edward I., when he was appointed for Herefordshire and for Surrey.¹ He died in 23 Edward I., 1295.²

NORTHBURG, WILLIAM DE.

· JUST. ITIN. 1275.

OF William de Northburg no memorial remains except that he was one of the justices appointed in 3 Edward I., 1275, to take assizes beyond the Trent; and that in 6 and 7 Edward I. he acted as a justice itinerant in the counties of Hereford, Hertford, Kent, Dorset, Somerset, and Wilts.³ He is mentioned in that character at Lancaster in 23 Edward I., but apparently in reference to a plea of earlier date.⁴

NORTHWOOD, ROGER DE.

B. E. 1274.

NORTHWOOD-CHASTENERS is a manor near Milton in Kent, and was granted in the reign of King John to Stephen, the son of Jordan de Shepey, who built a mansion there and assumed its name. His son, Roger de Northwood, who was with King Richard in the Holy Land, was, by Bona his wife, father of Roger, the subject of the present notice. In 42 Henry III. he accounted for the proceeds of the sheriffalty of Kent as one of the executors of Reginald de Cobbeham; and was possessed, besides the above manor, of that of Littlebrooke in Stone, near Dartford, and of Shorne, Thurneham, Harietsham, and Northwood without Shepey, and other property in the

¹ Dugdale's Chron. Series.

² Dugdale's Chron. Series.

³ Cal. Inquis. p. m., i. 124.

⁴ Abbrev. Rot. Orig. i. 92.

same county. In 41 Henry III. he procured the tenure of his lands to be changed from gavelkind to knights' service.¹

He must have been a baron of the Exchequer in 2 Edward I., since he is mentioned as being present in that character on the feast of St. Edmund the Martyr, November 20, 1274, the first day of the third regnal year of that monarch. On July 25 following, he received a grant of 10*l.* for his expenses; and in November another of 20*l.*; and subsequently a regular salary of forty marks per annum. In 5 Edward I. he was excused from his service in the army against Wales on account of his residence in the Exchequer; and there is sufficient proof of his continuing in the office till his death, which occurred in the thirteenth year.² His son John was summoned to parliament; as were his successors till 49 Edward III. The male line failing in 1416, the barony, on the death of John, the grandson of the last who was summoned, fell into abeyance among the representatives of his sisters.³

ODYHAM, WALTER DE.

? KEEPER, 1284.

WHEN Bishop Burnel, the chancellor, paid one of his occasional visits to his mansion at Acton Burnell on July 25, 1284, he left the Great Seal in the custody of Hugh de Kendal and Walter de Odyham.⁴ On this account they are placed in Mr. Hardy's catalogue among the keepers of the seal. Both of them, however, probably were simply clerks in Chancery. Hugh de Kendal certainly bore that office two years afterwards⁵; and several letters and writs

¹ Hasted's Kent, i. 181. 184., ii. 389., iii. 444., v. 447. 522., vi. 177. 251.

² Madox's Exch. i. 726., ii. 20. 62. 112. 269. 320.; Abbrev. Placit. 201.; Cal. Inquis. p. m., i. 86.

³ Dugdale's Baronage, ii. 70.; Nicolas's Synopsis.

⁴ Pat. 12 Edw. I., m. 7.

⁵ Madox's Exch. ii. 257.

are addressed to Walter de Odyham separately, as well as to them both jointly, on the business of the Chancery. It has been already remarked under Hugh de Kendall that some of these bear date in 1283.

ORMESBY, WILLIAM DE.

JUST. ITIN. 1292. JUST. K. B. 1296.

See under the Reign of Edward II.

OSGODBY, ADAM DE.

M. R. 1295. ? KEEPER, 1302.

See under the Reign of Edward II.

PENECESTRE, STEPHEN DE.

JUST. C. P. 1284.

ALTHOUGH Dugdale introduces the name of Stephen de Penecestre (Penshurst) in his list of judges of the Common Pleas, quoting the "Communia" of Trinity Term, 12 Edward I., there is considerable doubt whether he ever held that office or sat at all on the bench at Westminster. He certainly was often employed in a judicial character, but it seems to have been in his capacity of warden of the Cinque Ports.

The manor of Penshurst in Kent belonged to him, and at the latter part of the reign of Henry III. was held by Sir John Belemeyns, a canon of St. Paul's, as his uncle and trustee. He also possessed the manor of West Leigh and the castle of Allington in the same county. Before 1270, 54 Henry III., he had married Roese de Beseville, and in that year did homage, with Joanna, her sister, for the lands which had belonged to their mother, Hawise.¹ He was

sheriff of Kent in 53 Henry III., and the two following years; and in 55 or 56 Henry III. was appointed constable of Dover Castle and warden of the Cinque Ports, posts for which he received 30*l.* a year to cover the expenses of chaplains and servants, and which he retained as late as 33 Edward I.¹ There are several instances of his being assigned to try malefactors and to decide rights within his jurisdiction², but none that show him to have been one of the regular judges.

His second wife was Margaret, one of the three daughters and coheirs of John de Burgh, the grandson of Hubert de Burgh. Hasted says that after his death she married Robert de Orreby, but it is evident that Orreby must have been her first husband. Stephen de Penecestre was alive in 1305, 33 Edward I., and Margaret on her death in 1309, 2 Edward II., is described by his name; and further, John de Orreby, "son of Margaret, who was the wife of Stephen de Penecestre deceased," did homage for her lands in Kent in the same year, when, if there had been a subsequent marriage, he could not have been more than three years old. Stephen de Penecestre left two daughters and coheirs; Joane, married to Henry de Cobbeham of Rundall; and Alice, married to John de Columbers. He largely endowed the Free Chapel of his manor of Penshurst, and lies buried in the church there under an altar tomb, on which he is represented in armour, and not in judicial robes.³

¹ Excerpt. e Rot. Fin. ii. 552.; Madox's Exch. i. 613.; Abb. Rot. Orig. i. 47.

² Rot. Parl. i. 3. 18. 98. 126.; Abbrev. Placit. 903.

³ Hasted's Kent, i. 182., iii. 75. 231. 255. 259. 272., iv. 450., vi. 84.; Abbrev. Rot. Orig. i. 162. 164.

PICHEFORD, GEOFFREY DE.

? JUST. ITIN. 1278.

GEOFFREY DE PICHEFORD was probably the son of Ralph de Picheford, and was under age when his father died, in 1252, 36 Henry III.; and his wardship and the custody of his lands in Shropshire were granted to Ralph Fitz-Nicholas for a fine of 100 marks.¹ He was constable of the castle and forest of Windsor in 1 Edward I.², and was a justice itinerant of the forests before the eighth year, 1278, the period named in Dugdale's List, when he was appointed to act in Wiltshire, as he is referred to in that character in Hampshire two years previously, in a petition to the parliament then held. He was still engaged in the same employment in 18 Edward I.; and was afterwards Queen Eleanor's bailiff at Langley.³ The last time any record of his name appears is as constable of Windsor Castle, in 26 Edward I.⁴

PRESTON, GILBERT DE.

CH. C. P. 1272.

See under the Reign of Henry III.

WALTER DE PRESTON, the father of Gilbert de Preston, was in the service of King John. He was sheriff of the county of Northampton in the eighth and ninth years of that reign, and afterwards held some office in connection with the Forests. He seems also to have had the custody of the castle of Fotheringay; and at the close of the reign to have deserted his royal master for a short time. On the accession of Henry III., he not only recovered his lands, but was retained in the king's employ. On several occasions he had orders to take a number of bucks in the forests for the king's

¹ Excerpt. e Rot. Fin. ii. 141.² Abbrev. Rot. Orig. i. 21.³ Rot. Parl. i. 4. 59., ii. 81.⁴ Madox's Exch. ii. 224.